

ENGLISH EXPRESSIONS

TO TALK ABOUT WORK

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Helping you Become a Confident English Speaker

Many IELTS students lack confidence in their speaking skills.

The Keith Speaking Academy helps you develop your speaking skills so you can face the examiner with confidence and ace the IELTS test.

This PDF is one of many that Keith has developed to help you do this.



Keith has been working in international education for over 20 years as a teacher, teacher trainer, and education manager.

He has helped over 40,000 students prepare for their IELTS Speaking test with his online courses.

In this PDF, we are going to look at some great expressions to help you talk confidently and naturally about your job, in English.

We will look at natural, spoken expressions about work that you can use to talk about,

- Job Interviews
- Responsibilities at Work
- Being Busy
- Changing Jobs

Let's do it!



Expressions for job interviews

If you have to speak English in a job interview, you want to make a good impression with both your English skills and also by showing yourself to be the best candidate for the job.

Here are some great phrases to help you do that.

To say that you are the right person for the job, you can say,

- *I think I am **a good fit** for this job*
- *I think I am **a good match** for this job*
- *This job **suits me down to the ground***
- *I think this job **ties in with** my future plans*

In order to show your enthusiasm and also show you want to help the company be successful, you can say,

- *I am excited to **showcase my skills***
- *I am eager to **make a contribution***
- *I am sure I can **bring a lot to** this job*

Finally, you want to give the impression that you are ready to work hard, so you can use this phrase,

- *I never **shy away from** hard work*

Job interview tips

Here are some great tips to help you do your best in any job interview.

1. Do your **homework** (research the company and its goals, values and activities)
2. Use **words the company uses** (use the same language they use to describe their company)
3. **Focus on your ability** more than qualification (it's the only way to make you seem different from the rest)
4. Focus on **giving** as well as taking
5. **Choose** as well as be chosen (find out if the company is right for you)
6. **Ask good questions**

One of the best questions at the end of an interview is

- ***“What will success look like for this job?”***

It shows you care, and helps you better understand the job!

Expressions about work responsibilities

So after a successful interview, you have **landed the job** (= got the job), and now it's time to start working. Inevitably you need to tell friends, family and even other work colleagues what it is you do exactly.

Here are some great expressions to talk about your responsibilities and skills.

I'm in charge of _____

I'm responsible for _____

It's down to me to _____

- ***I'm in charge of*** the company's marketing strategy. That means, ***I'm responsible for*** setting our marketing goals. On top of that, ***it's down to me to*** make sure we meet all our marketing goals.

If you want to talk about your skills and what you are good at, you can say,

My forte is _____

I excel at _____

- ***My forte is*** making creative graphics and ***I excel at*** graphics for Facebook advertisements

Expressions to describe being busy at work

You will quickly realise that working life is all about being busy. Even if you are not busy, you sometimes have to pretend to be busy. No manager likes to see their workers with nothing to do!

Here are some great phrases to describe being busy in English.

- I'm **snowed under**
- **I'm swamped** with work
- I've **got a lot on my plate**
- I'm **up to my neck in** work
- I'm **up to my neck in** deadlines

Changing jobs

The days of working for your whole career in one company are rapidly disappearing. Nowadays, job hopping is a common trend. Young people may spend a few months in one job to get some experience or learn some new skills, and then ‘hop’ or move to a new job for the next six months. And then move again.

Here are some phrases to talk about your desire to change job.

- ***It's time to move on***
- ***It's time to move on to a new challenge***
- ***I want to make a career change***

In addition, you can use these phrase below to give a reason why you want to change. In this case, they mean you are bored or feel you can do so much more if given the chance.

- ***I'm stuck in a rut***
- ***I'm not realising my potential***
- ***I've got untapped potential***

So, all in all, you have some awesome phrases here that you can use to describe different stages of your employee life cycle.

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